

Study Guide: Foundations of Acupuncture and the Lung Channel

This study guide is based on the comprehensive principles and clinical applications detailed in *A Manual of Acupuncture* by Peter Deadman, Mazin Al-Khafaji, and Kevin Baker. It focuses on channel theory, point categories, selection methods, and the specific applications of the Lung channel of Hand Taiyin.

Part I: Knowledge Review Quiz

Short-Answer Questions

Please answer each question in 2-3 sentences based on the provided text.

1. **Explain the difference between "Jing" and "Luo" within the channel and collateral system.**
2. **Describe the two primary theories regarding the historical discovery of acupuncture channels.**
3. **What are the specific clinical functions of Jing-well points?**
4. **How do the Xi-cleft points of the yin channels differ from those of the yang channels?**
5. **Explain the "Host and Guest" method of combining acupuncture points.**
6. **What is the significance of the "Window of Heaven" points in treating "Inversion Qi"?**
7. **Describe the anatomical method for determining the "Cun" measurement on a patient's hand.**
8. **Identify the three "Command Points" located on the Lung and Large Intestine channels and their areas of influence.**
9. **Why is the Lung channel (Hand Taiyin) said to originate in the Middle Jiao?**
10. **What is the clinical significance of "Cross Needling" (contralateral insertion)?**

Part II: Answer Key

1. **Jing and Luo Distinction:** "Jing" refers to the "channels" which act like the trunk and main branches of a tree, running longitudinally and deeply to connect with the internal Zangfu. "Luo" refers to the "collaterals" or net-like finer branches that are more superficial, interconnecting the main channels with the cutaneous regions and connective tissues.
2. **Discovery Theories:** The first theory suggests that observation of tender spots (Ahshi points) during disease led to the discovery of points, which were later linked into channels. The second theory proposes that channels were discovered first through propagated sensations during massage or meditation, with specific points being identified along those pathways later.
3. **Jing-well Point Functions:** Jing-well points are primarily used to clear heat, restore consciousness, and rescue collapse due to their dynamic effect on Qi. They also treat the uppermost reaches of their respective channels and are effective for treating stagnation or fullness in the chest (below the Heart) and disorders of the spirit.

4. **Xi-cleft Point Differences:** In general, Xi-cleft points are used to treat acute conditions and pain where Qi and Blood gather and plunge deeply. However, the Xi-cleft points of the yin channels have the additional specific action of treating disorders of the Blood, such as acute bleeding or stasis.
5. **Host and Guest Method:** This method involves combining the Yuan-source point of the primarily affected channel (the "Host") with the Luo-connecting point of its interiorly-exteriorly coupled channel (the "Guest"). This combination is used to treat disorders affecting both the Zangfu and the paired channels simultaneously.
6. **Window of Heaven and Inversion Qi:** These points treat "Inversion Qi," a state of chaotic, rebellious Qi where Qi or Blood rebels upward toward the head. They are indicated for symptoms such as sudden loss of voice, goitre, scrofula, and disharmony between the Qi of the body and the head.
7. **Hand Cun Measurements:** One "Cun" is defined as the width of the interphalangeal joint of the thumb or the distance between the creases of the middle finger's interphalangeal joint. Three "Cun" is measured as the combined width of the four fingers (index to little finger) held close together at the level of the proximal interphalangeal joint.
8. **Command Points:** Lieque LU-7 is the command point for the head and nape, while Hegu L.I.-4 is the command point for the face and mouth. These points are considered the most vital for treating any disorder—whether acute, chronic, hot, or cold—within their respective anatomical regions.
9. **Lung Channel Origin:** The Lung primary channel originates in the Middle Jiao (the region of the Stomach) to establish a physiological link with the digestive system. This explains why Lung points like Zhongfu LU-1 and Chize LU-5 are indicated for descending rebellious Stomach Qi, such as vomiting or difficult ingestion.
10. **Cross Needling:** Cross needling, or contralateral insertion, involves treating the right side of the body for a left-sided disorder and vice-versa. This is used when the affected side is too painful to needle or when a practitioner wishes for the patient to mobilize the injured area during treatment.

Part III: Essay Questions

1. **The Dynamics of Qi Flow:** Compare and contrast the centripetal flow of Qi described in Five Shu point theory (moving from distal extremities to the elbows/knees) with the self-contained circular circulation of the twelve primary channels.
2. **The Role of Extraordinary Vessels:** Discuss the function of the Eight Extraordinary Vessels as "reservoirs" for the primary channels and their role in circulating defensive Qi to protect the body.
3. **The Interconnection of Zangfu and Channels:** Using the Lung channel as an example, analyze how the internal pathways of a channel (specifically its connections to the Stomach and Large Intestine) influence the clinical indications of its external points.
4. **Theoretical Contradictions in Point Usage:** Evaluate the use of Five Phase "Mother-Child" points in clinical practice, discussing why some points (like Taiyuan LU-9) follow the theory of tonification/reduction while others (like Quchi L.I.-11) are used primarily for their empirical actions.

5. **The Clinical Utility of Distal Point Selection:** Explain the principle of "Selecting Points Below to Treat Above," specifically focusing on how distal points on the limbs act as the "root" to treat manifestations in the head and chest.

Part IV: Glossary of Key Terminology

Term, Definition

Ahshi Points, Points of local tenderness found on palpation that are needled regardless of whether they are standard channel points.

Back-Shu Points, Twelve points on the Bladder channel where the Qi of the Zangfu is transported to the back; used for both diagnosis and treatment.

Cun, A proportional unit of measurement used in acupuncture to locate points accurately across different body sizes.

Deqi, "The sensation of the ""arrival of Qi,"" often described as heaviness, numbness, or aching upon needle insertion."

Divergent Channels, Branches of the primary channels that have no points of their own but strengthen the internal links between paired Zangfu.

Front-Mu Points, Points on the chest or abdomen where the Qi of the Zangfu gathers; primarily used to treat the Zangfu organs directly.

Hui-Meeting Points, "Eight specific points that have a special influence over tissues or functions: Zang, Fu, Qi, Blood, Sinews, Vessels, Bone, and Marrow."

Jiao, "One of the three ""burners"" or divisions of the body: Upper (Chest/Lung/Heart), Middle (Stomach/Spleen), and Lower (Intestines/Bladder/Kidneys)."

Luo-Connecting Points, Points where the Luo-collaterals diverge to connect with the interiorly-exteriorly related channel.

Pneumothorax, "A medical emergency caused by air entering the pleural cavity, often resulting from excessively deep or improper needling of the chest or back."

Running Piglet Qi, "A traditional symptom involving a sensation of Qi rushing upward from the abdomen to the throat, often associated with fear or palpitations."

Shan Disorder, "A category of disorders typically involving hernia-like symptoms, swelling of the scrotum, or lower abdominal pain."

Sinew Channels, Superficial pathways following major muscle groups and tendons; they do not penetrate the internal Zangfu.

Xi-Cleft Points, ""Cleft"" or ""crevice"" points where Qi and Blood gather and plunge deeply; used for acute conditions and pain."

Yuan-Source Points, "Points on the primary channels where the ""Original Qi"" surfaces and lingers; used to tonify the Zang or dispel excess from the Fu."

Zangfu, "The collective term for the five yin ""Zang"" (solid) organs and the six yang ""Fu"" (hollow) organs of Chinese medicine."